Levin S. Güver

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Employment

Current

2026– **Postdoctoral Researcher & Inaugural 'Normz' Teaching Fellow**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
— Zurich Program on Law and Normative Reflection ('Normz')

2023– **Research Associate**
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Graz
— Chair of Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

Previous

2023–2025 **Graduate Lecturer**
Faculty of Law, University College London

2019–2023 **Research Assistant**
Faculty of Law & Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich
— Chair of Applied Ethics (2019–23)
— Chair of Criminal Law, Criminal Procedure Law, and Criminology (2022)
— Chair of Philosophy and Theory of Law, Legal Soc., and Int. Publ. Law (2020–22)
— 'Fundamental Psychological Dispositions in Human-Robot Interactions' (2020)

Education

Degrees

2022–2026 **Ph.D. in Law**
Faculty of Law & Dpt. of Philosophy, University College London
Supervised by Mark Dsouza and John Hyman
Examined by Antony Duff and Leo Zaibert (*no corrections*)

2019–2021 **Master of Law**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
summa cum laude, Valedictorian (rank 1/215)

2015–2019 **Bachelor of Law**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

Research Stays

2025 **Yale Law School**
Invited by Gideon Yaffe and Joshua Knobe (Feb–May 2025)

2023, 2025 **Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law**
Invited by Philipp-Alexander Hirsch (Jun–Sep 2023) and Sabine Gless (Jun–Aug 2025)

Publications

Articles

2025 **'Causation, Norms, and Cognitive Bias'** (with M. Kneer). *Cognition*, 259, 106105.

2025 **'Untangling the Gordian Knot of Motive'**. *Journal of Legal Philosophy*, 50(1), pp. 1–26.
— winner of ASLP Essay Prize
— runner-up for Young Scholar Prize

2024 **'The Unity of Motive'**. *Argumenta*, 9(2), pp. 231–245.
— winner of Lex Academic Prize
— runner-up for NEN Paper Prize

Book Chapters

2026 **'Understanding the Mentalist Theory of Law and Morality'**. In S. Summers & A. Sajo (eds.), *Human Rights Restated: An Investigation of Mind and Rights* (pp. tbd). Cambridge University Press.

2023 **'Causation and the Silly Norm Effect'** (with M. Kneer). In S. Magen & K. Prochownik (eds.), *Advances in Experimental Philosophy of Law* (pp. 133–168). Bloomsbury Press.
— runner-up for William James Prize

Peer-Reviewed Proceedings

2023 **'Causation, Foreseeability, and Norms'** (with M. Kneer). *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 45, pp. 888–895.

Other

2024 **'Criminalisation and Its Limits'**. *Criminal Justice Theory Blog*, online Nov 15th.

2023 **'Motive and Criminal Liability'**. *Criminal Justice Theory Blog*, online Aug 4th.

2019 **'From *Is* to *Ought*: How Scientific Research in the Field of Moral Cognition Can Impact the Criminal Law'**. *Cognitio: Student Law Forum*, 1(2), pp. 1–22.

Teaching

† = undergraduate [8], ‡ = graduate [3]

Co-Instructor

Fall '26 **Legal Philosophy** †
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

Spring '26 **Crime, Punishment, and Equality** ‡
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

Winter '25 ***Wrongs and Crimes*: Rethinking Consent, Coercion, and State Power** ‡
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Fall '21 **Theory and Philosophy of Law** †
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

GRADUATE LECTURER

Terms 1–2 '23, '24 **Criminal Law** †
Faculty of Law, University College London

Term 1 '23, '24 **Introduction to Law** †
Faculty of Law, University College London
— Case Study on *Medical Accidents* (Term 1 '24)
— Case Study on *Fake News and Falsehoods* (Term 1 '23)

TUTOR

Fall '21 **Blame and Punishment** †
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Fall '20 **Theories of Morality** ‡
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Spring '20 ***The View from Nowhere*: Objectivity and Subjectivity in Practical Philosophy** †
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Awards

SCHOLARSHIPS AND PRIZES

2025–2026 **Research Excellence Scholarship for Cross-Disciplinary Training**
University-wide competition to fully fund a continuation of one's studies in a different department – in my case, UCL Philosophy.

2025 **Yale–UCL Scholarship**
Full funding for research stay at Yale University.

2024 **ASLP Essay Prize**
Awarded by the Australasian Society of Legal Philosophy for best paper in legal theory.

2024 **Lex Academic Prize**
Awarded by Lex Academic, SIFA & *Argumenta* for best paper in action theory and ethics.

2024 **NEN Paper Prize (finalist)**
Runner-up for best submission at the Northeast Normativity Workshop essay competition.

2023 **Project Development Grant**
Awarded by Clearer Thinking Foundation for 'Understanding Moral Luck' project.

2023 **Young Scholar Prize (finalist)**
Runner-up for best submission in practical philosophy at the 15th SIFA Conference.

2023, 2025 **Max Planck Fellowship**
Full funding for research stay at the MPI for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law.

2022–2025	**Research Excellence Scholarship & Overseas Research Scholarship** UCL's most prestigious funding package 'awarded only to the most outstanding potential and existing research students from all departments and faculties'.
2022–2026	**Hollond-Whittaker Research Studentship (declined)** Full funding to study at Trinity College, University of Cambridge.
2022	**Poster Prize** Best poster at the 3rd SPP and ESPP Joint Conference.
2021	**Orelli Prize** Biannually awarded by the Faculty of Law of UZH for an 'extraordinary thesis'.
2021	**William James Prize (finalist)** Runner-up for best graduate submission at the 47th Soc. for Phil. and Psych. Conference.
2019–2020	**Clinton Fellowship** Awarded by ETH Zurich and Clinton Foundation for 'Urban Classroom' project.

COMPETITIVE CONFERENCE FUNDING

2023 (4×)	**Neuchâtel Action Conference** (Neuchâtel); **27th Oxford Graduate Conference in Philosophy** (Oxford); **45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society** (Sydney, ceded); **Philosophy and Computer Science Summer School** (Bayreuth)
2020	**12th Clinton Global Initiative University Conference** (Edinburgh)

Talks

† = refereed [21], ‡ = invited [14], ▽ = received comments [5]

PAPER PRESENTATIONS

'LLMs, Naked Statistical Evidence, and Legal Proof' (in German)

Sep 2026 — 34th Young Forum for Legal Philosophy, University of Zurich †

'Intentions, *de dicto* and *de re*'

Sep 2025 — 12th German Society for Analytic Philosophy Congress, HHU Düsseldorf †

'Ordinary Recklessness Wrongdoing'

Nov 2025 — Work-in-Progress Series, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law ‡

Feb 2025 — Experimental Philosophy Lab, Yale University

'Making Sense of Mistakes of Fact'

May 2025 — Foundations of Criminal Responsibility Workshop, Cambridge Univ. ‡ ▽ ▽

Mar 2025 — Cambridge Legal Theory Discussion Group, Cambridge University † ▽

Nov 2024 — Edinburgh Criminal Law Discussion Group, Edinburgh University †

Jul 2024 — Philosophy Department Colloquium, Univ. of Erlangen-Nuremberg ‡

May 2024 — Criminal Law Group Brown Bag Lunch, University of Zurich ‡

'The Significance of Philosophy of Action for Criminal Law'

Sep 2024 Theorising Criminal Law Workshop, University of Zurich ‡

'Causation, Norms, and Cognitive Bias'

Jul 2024 Experimental Jurisprudence Workshop, University of Surrey ‡

'Untangling the Gordian Knot of Motive'

Feb 2024 Edinburgh Criminal Law Discussion Group, Edinburgh University †

Feb 2024 Criminal Jurisprudence and Philosophy Group, Cambridge University †

Nov 2023 Cambridge Legal Theory Discussion Group, Cambridge University † ▽

Sep 2023 Criminal Law Department Meeting, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law

'The Unity of Motive'

Dec 2023 Neuchâtel Action Conference, University of Neuchâtel †

Nov 2023 27th Oxford Graduate Conference in Philosophy, Oxford University † ▽

Sep 2023 15th Conference of the Italian Society for Analytic Philosophy, University of Eastern Piedmont †

— runner-up for Young Scholar Prize

Jul 2023 97th Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association, Open Session, Birkbeck, University of London †

'Closeness and Double Effect'

Sep 2022 Conference for Young Analytic Philosophy, University of Salzburg †

'Causation, Foreseeability, and Norms'

Jul 2023 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Univ. of Sydney †

Jul 2022 3rd Joint Conference of the Soc. for Philosophy and Psychology and European Soc. for Philosophy and Psychology, Univ. of Milan (poster) †

— winner of Poster Prize

Jul 2022 30th International Association for Philosophy of Law and Social Philosophy World Congress, SW 21, Dimitrie Cantemir Christian Univ. of Bucharest †

Feb 2022 Doctoral Students Day: Perspectives on Philosophy in Switzerland, Univ. of Basel (poster) †

'Misascription of Action-Descriptions'

Sep 2022 17th Conference of the Swiss Psychological Society, Univ. of Zurich †

Jun 2022 UK-IVR 2022 Annual Conference, University of Surrey †

Jun 2020 1st European Experimental Philosophy Conf., Charles Univ. Prague †

'Causation and the Silly Norm Effect'

Oct 2021 Georgetown Lab for the Empirical Study of Law and Language, Georgetown University ‡

Oct 2021 Reasons and Decisions Lab, Lake Forest College ‡

Sep 2021 28th Conference of the European Society for Philosophy and Psychology, University of Leipzig †

Aug 2021 Law, Language, and Philosophy Summer School, Inter-University Centre Dubrovnik

Jun 2021 47th Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Princeton University †
— runner-up for William James Prize

Jun 2021 2nd European Experimental Philosophy Conf., Charles Univ. Prague †

'Action, Intention, and Double Effect'

May 2021 Values and Reasons Research Colloquium, University of Zurich

'Anscombe, Davidson, and Criminal Law'

May 2020 Values and Reasons Research Colloquium, University of Zurich

'Inculpating Mental States Across Cultures'

Jul 2019 29th International Association for Philosophy of Law and Social Philosophy World Congress, SW 148, University of Lucerne

COMMENTS

JP Fassnidge: 'Criminalisation Theories: A Meta-Normative Inquiry'

Nov 2025 Book Workshop, University of Aberdeen ‡

David Chandler: 'Back to the Phineas Gage Effect'

Sep 2025 Philosophy Graduate Conference, University College London ‡

Lewis Ross: 'What Does the End of Punishment Mean?'

Jun 2025 The Distinctiveness of the Criminal Standard of Proof, Univ. of Zurich ‡

Shraddha Chaudhary: 'The Moral Wrongs of Sexual Exploitation'

May 2025 Criminal Law and Philosophy Conference, University of York

Anna Peters: 'The Duty to Criminalise'

Dec 2024 Philosophy, Law, and Politics Graduate Forum, King's College London ‡

Manuel Cordes: 'Criminal Responsibility as Reasons-Responsiveness'

Dec 2024 ECR Workshop, University of Glasgow ‡

Philipp Hirsch: 'How Criminal Law Disapproves of Our Reasons for Action'

Nov 2024 Centre for Criminal Law, University College London ‡

Daniel Miller: 'Why Culpable Ignorance Requires Awareness'

Sep 2024 Workshop on Wilful Blindness and Mistakes of Fact, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law ‡

Joshua May: 'Are Rights a Rationalization?'

Jun 2024 Workshop on M. Mahlmann's *Mind and Rights*, University of Zurich ‡

GUEST LECTURES

'Experimental Jurisprudence' (in German)

Jul 2026 Introduction to Experimental Philosophy, Heidelberg University ‡

Legal Practice

2019–2022 **Legal Consultant**
Levuro (Tech Start-Up)

Jul–Aug 2019 **Law Firm Intern**
Schwärzler Attorneys at Law

Sep 2018 **Court Intern**
District Court Andelfingen, Canton of Zurich

Summer Schools

Jul 2023 **Philosophy and Computer Science**
University of Bayreuth

Aug 2021 **Law, Language, and Philosophy**
Inter-University Centre Dubrovnik

Jul 2021 **Causation and Responsibility**
University of Berne

Jul 2021 **Ancient Philosophy**
University College London

Volunteer and Outreach

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Sep 2023 **'Understanding Moral Luck'**
Clearer Thinking Foundation
Project aimed at making the ethical implications of moral luck accessible to the public.

Jun 2022 **Career Forum Speaker**
International School of Schaffhausen (ISSH)
Introduced prospects in law and philosophy to ca. 25 high schoolers.

2021 **Graduate Student Representative of Switzerland**
Youth Forum on the Future of the Humanities (EHC 2021)
Formulated recommendations in cooperation with the Portuguese National Funding Agency, International Council for Philosophy and Human Sciences, and UNESCO.

2019–2021 **'Urban Classroom'**
Clinton Global Initiative University (CGI U)
Project aimed at making expert knowledge accessible to the public (led a group of three).

2018–2020 **Legal Consultant**
University of Zurich Student Association (VSUZH)
Free legal consultation open to all UZH and ETH students (150+ students assisted).

Interviews

May 2024 **'Ethics of Mass Surveillance'**
Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Art
Interviewed about legal and moral issues surrounding mass surveillance and AI.

Mar 2023 **'Boundaries between Law and Philosophy'**
The Philosopher's Nest Podcast
Interviewed about quandaries at the intersection of law and philosophy.

Workshops

Oct 2025 **'The Promises and Perils of AI in Education'**
International School of Schaffhausen (ISSH)
Gave a workshop to the teaching staff on the interplay between AI and good education.

Academic Citizenship and Supervision

† = Dpt. of Psychology

University College London

Writing Tutor

2024–2025 20× LLB
2023–2024 21× LLB

Academic Mentor

2023–2024 10× LLM

UCL Journal of Law and Jurisprudence

2022–2023 Editor

Research Essay Supervisor

Terms 1–2 '22 1× graduate (relation of law and liberty)

University of Zurich

Thesis Co-Supervisor

Fall '25 1× graduate (mental illness and criminal responsibility) †

Spring '24 3× graduate (biases in legal and moral decision-making) †

Spring '23 1× graduate (epistemology of criminal procedure law)

Spring '22 2× undergraduate (constitutional guarantees of freedom and equality)
2× graduate (sexual violence and consent in criminal law)

Fall '21 3× undergraduate (moral foundations of criminal law in relation to evolutionary biology, neuroscience, and behavioural economics)

Marking Assistant

Fall '26 Graduate course 'Legal Theory' (6 ECTS)

Spring '22 Undergraduate course 'Legal Philosophy' (3 ECTS)

Spring '21	Undergraduate courses 'Legal History' (6 ECTS) and 'Private Law II' (18 ECTS)
Fall '20	Undergraduate course 'Public Law I' (15 ECTS)

Referee

Full articles	Bloomsbury Press, *Cognitive Science* (2×), Cognitive Science Society (3×), *European Journal of Philosophy*, Northeast Normativity Workshop (2×), *Philosophical Quarterly*, *Studi di estetica*, *UCL Journal of Law and Jurisprudence*
Abstracts	AI Ethics and HCI Conference, GAP Conference